Tino Cardenes is a classical and jazz pianist, composer, and computer scientist whose work spans performance, composition, and music technology. He began studying piano at age four at the Carnegie Mellon Prep School with Luz Manriquez and grew up in a musical family, where someone was always practicing. His classical training expanded into jazz piano and improvisation in his high school years, which remain central to his musical life.

As a performer, Tino has appeared in a wide range of settings, from concerto performances to jazz and improvised music. He has performed with Paquito D'Rivera and the band for the Final Fantasy World Tour, and regularly works as an improvising pianist for private events and dance classes. He is the winner of the 2026 Carnegie Mellon Philharmonic soloist competition, despite not being a music performance student. Beyond performing, Tino co-founded the Shady Side Porch Concert Series, a Pittsburgh music festival that has featured Grammy Award-winning artists alongside emerging young musicians and raised thousands of dollars to support community music projects throughout the region.

At Carnegie Mellon University, Tino studies computer science and music technology, exploring the intersection of music, computation, and audio. His technical work includes full-stack development and the creation of VST plugins and other musical software, including tools for DX-7 emulation, MIDI delay algorithms, and visualizing harmonic relationships with relatime audio. He is also a teaching assistant and course developer for a computer music course, where he has worked on projects involving real-time synthesis and FM synthesis. His broader computer science interests include systems, realtime interactions, and microarchitectural security. Across his work, Tino is interested in how technology can expand musical possibilities while preserving the spontaneity, collaboration, and community of live music-making.